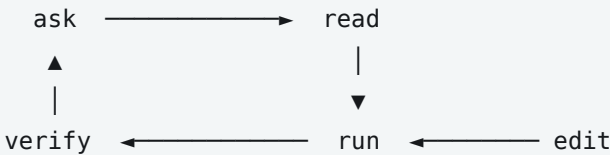


Cheatsheet

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The loop



Ask — say what you want, and say what you do not want. **Read** — it opens the files. If it did not read the file, it is guessing. **Edit** — it writes or changes code. **Run** — it executes the code and sees the output. **Verify** — **you** check. This step is not optional and cannot be delegated.

The agent can do four of the five. The fifth is the reason you are in the room.

Commands

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
claude	Start, in the current folder
Shift+Tab	Enter plan mode: it describes, it does not act
Esc	Stop what it is doing now
Esc Esc	Go back to an earlier point in the conversation
/clear	Empty the context and start again
/undo	Undo the last file change
@filename	Point it at a specific file
#	Save a note into <code>CLAUDE.md</code>
!command	Run a shell command yourself
/help	List everything else

Three habits

1. Ask for the plan before the code.

Reading a wrong plan takes ten seconds. Finding a wrong result takes a week.

2. Make it show you the output.

"The analysis found 114 significant genes" and a terminal printing 114 are different kinds of evidence. Accept the second.

3. Save the script, not the conversation.

The same prompt run twice gives different code. A script in version control is the only version of your analysis that still exists next month.

Three ways this goes wrong

Silent wrong answers. Code that runs, produces plausible numbers, and answers a slightly different question than you asked. Nothing looks broken.

Confident invention. Gene functions, pathway meanings, citations. Fluent, specific, and sometimes false. It reads exactly like the true answers.

Results you cannot reproduce. A number in a conversation that has scrolled away and cannot be regenerated.